

Quick Storage Fix

WhatsApp is eating your phone's storage

Here's the fix

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Say WhatsApp shows 18GB of storage used, but your actual chats only add up to 2GB. That gap is normal, and if your phone keeps nagging you about storage, this is probably why. Here's how to claw back gigabytes without deleting a single conversation.

 **Start with the number**
Go to WhatsApp, Settings,

Storage and Data, Manage Storage. The figure at the top is your real WhatsApp footprint. Compare it to what you'd guess your actual chats weigh.

 **Kill the forwards first**
On the same screen, scroll to Larger Than 5MB, then tap Forwarded Many Times. This is the stuff that circulates through family and friend groups on loop, festival videos, meme reels, the same clip forwarded by six different people. This single folder is often the biggest chunk of the cleanup,

easily several gigabytes on an active phone. Delete it and move on.

 **Clean chats without deleting them**

Back on Manage Storage, tap into your heaviest chats one by one. Do not hit Select All. Instead, select only Photos and Videos, then delete. The conversation history stays intact, only the media gets wiped. This is the safest cleanup step because you're not touching anything anyone actually typed.

 **For Android, go digging in the file system**

Open your File Manager app, then Internal Storage, WhatsApp, Databases. You'll find a stack of files named msgstore, each dated, each roughly 300 to 500MB. WhatsApp keeps daily backups of your chat database going back weeks, so seven or eight old files sitting there is common, and each one you clear adds up fast. Keep the most recent one and delete the rest. One caveat here, don't delete the current day's file, and if you're not confident about which one is live, leave a couple of the newest ones as a buffer.

 **The hidden folder nobody checks**

Still in File Manager, go to WhatsApp, Media, then look for a folder called .Statuses. The dot at the front means it's hidden from your gallery app, which is exactly why it never gets cleaned. It quietly stores every status and story you've viewed, and on a phone with a few hundred contacts that can easily run past a gigabyte on its own. Select all, delete.

 **iPhone users, the same logic applies**

Go to WhatsApp, Settings, Storage, and Delete Items. Then separately go to Settings, Chats, and turn off Save to Camera Roll, so media stops duplicating into your Photos app. 

